

Seasonal preservation planner

Category	Planner - Reference - Take-home handout
Skill level	Grab & go. A one-page reference - print it and hand it out, or pull it up on the tablet. No prep beyond printing.
Audience	Teens & Adults. A practical planning tool (what is in season locally and the best way to preserve it).
Setup time	2-5 minutes

DESCRIPTION

A one-page Willamette Valley (Marion & Yamhill County) planner showing which produce is at peak each month and the best way to preserve it, color-coded by method. Great as a take-home handout and as a conversation starter ("here is what is in season right now - here is how to put it up"). The digital version lets you tap any month to see produce with processing notes and yields.

MATERIALS NEEDED

Print (hand it out)

- The "seasonal-planner-color.pdf" (full color) and/or "seasonal-planner-bw.pdf" (black & white, reads clearly when photocopied). US Letter, one page.

Digital version (tablet)

- Open the planner: sign in to the MFP Volunteer Resource Hub, tap "Toolkit," then "Open planner" on the Seasonal preservation planner card. Tap any month to see what is at peak, with processing notes and yields.

Both

- Table and MFP / OSU Extension signage. A stack of the printed planner to give away.
- This Activity guide on the table.

SETUP

1. Print a stack of the planner (color for display, black & white for easy photocopying and giveaways).
2. Optional: open the digital planner on the tablet to the current month.

ACTIVITY DIRECTIONS

Using it at a table

1. Ask the visitor what they grow or buy at the market.
2. Point to the current month on the planner (or tap it on the tablet) and show what is at peak.
3. Read the color-coded best method and the key tips (the digital version shows full processing notes and yields).
4. Hand them a printed copy to take home.

VOLUNTEER NOTES

- This is a reference, not a quiz - use it to start a planning conversation.
- Peak months reflect typical Willamette Valley seasons; an early or late year may shift things a week or two.
- Accuracy matters: read the methods and tips as written; refer detailed recipe questions to a Master Food Preserver or the cited OSU publications.
- The black & white version is designed to stay readable when photocopied - use it for giveaways.

- The QR box is a placeholder; ask your coordinator for the current OSU Extension food-preservation link to print over it.